

Lankford Legends – AI-Powered Features

I built this app because I wanted something better than refreshing Yahoo Fantasy and hoping I made the right start/sit call. What started as a weekend project turned into a full AI-powered fantasy baseball command center that knows my team, my league, and what the experts are saying — before I even wake up.

Overnight Intelligence Pipeline

Every morning at 3 AM, the app automatically:

1. **Pulls the latest fantasy baseball articles** from FanGraphs, Pitcher List, and RotoWire
2. **Downloads new podcast episodes** from CBS Fantasy Baseball Today, FantasyPros, Locked On Fantasy Baseball, and In This League
3. **Transcribes the podcasts** using local speech-to-text
4. **Feeds everything to AI** along with my league data — my roster, my opponent's roster, standings, free agents, and last week's results
5. **Generates a personalized daily briefing** with expert-backed analysis specific to my team

By the time I check my phone in the morning, there's a fresh intelligence report waiting — not generic fantasy advice, but analysis tailored to my exact situation in a 10-team H2H Points keeper league.

Daily Intelligence Reports

The flagship feature. AI reads through all the expert content from the previous day and cross-references it with my league data to produce a multi-section briefing:

- **Roster Intel** — Every player on my team gets a sentiment rating (Bullish, Bearish, or Neutral) with a recommended action (Start, Sit, Sell, Drop) and a confidence level. Trend arrows show how sentiment shifted from the previous report.
- **Matchup Preview** — A narrative breakdown of my head-to-head opponent this week: where I have the edge, where I'm vulnerable, and which players to watch.
- **Waiver Targets** — Free agents the experts are talking about, filtered and ranked for fit with my team's specific weak spots.
- **Trade Signals** — Sell-high candidates on my roster and buy-low targets on other teams, backed by expert reasoning and projection analysis.

- **Injury Watch** — Context beyond the official injury report: what the experts are saying about timelines, workload concerns, and fantasy impact.
- **Cardinals Corner** — I'm a Cardinals fan, so every report includes a dedicated section on STL players across the league.
- **Sibling Rivalry** — My brother's in the league too. The report tracks his team's strengths and weaknesses so I always know where I stand.
- **Action Items** — A concrete checklist of every recommendation, ordered by urgency.

Full weekly reports on Saturdays expand to 11 sections including a recap of last week's matchup and how my players performed.

AI Chat Assistant

There's a conversational assistant available on every page that I can ask anything:

- **Look up any player's stats** — batting, pitching, Statcast metrics, splits, by any time period
- **Compare players side-by-side** — up to 5 at once with percentile rankings
- **Evaluate trades** — it uses my league's exact scoring system to calculate surplus value
- **Find waiver pickups** — identifies free agents that fit my roster's needs
- **Check today's matchups** — streaming pitcher picks, hitter stacks, weather
- **Answer any fantasy question** — "Should I start Witt or Betts this week?" with reasoning tied to my scoring format

The assistant knows my league's custom scoring rules (saves are worth 7 points, holds are 4, strikeouts cost half a point for hitters) and factors them into every recommendation. It's not a generic chatbot — it's connected to my actual league data.

Smart Lineup Optimizer

The weekly lineup tool combines three layers of analysis:

1. **Mathematical optimization** — an integer linear programming solver finds the optimal lineup configuration across all position slots, factoring in multi-position eligibility
2. **Four-phase matchup adjustments** — each player's projection is adjusted for opposing pitcher quality, team offense, park factors, and platoon splits
3. **AI start/sit recommendations** — informed by that morning's expert intel, the AI explains why specific moves make sense in plain English

I get specific swap suggestions with projected point gains, plus narrative reasoning that references what the experts are saying. It's like having a fantasy analyst on staff.

Weekly Preview Column

One button press generates a full analyst-style column covering my matchup for the week — written like something you'd read on ESPN or The Athletic:

- Head-to-head storyline with edges and vulnerabilities
- Projection analysis comparing multiple systems
- Key players to watch on both sides
- Schedule advantages, park factors, and weather
- Injury concerns and their fantasy impact
- League standings context and playoff positioning

The preview pulls in insights from my daily intel pipeline, so it's not just numbers — it weaves in what FanGraphs writers, podcast hosts, and analysts are actually saying about the players in my matchup.

Waiver Wire AI

The waiver page scores every available player using a composite of:

- Rest-of-season projections from multiple systems (Steamer, ZiPS, ATC)
- My league's specific scoring weights
- Schedule factors (games this week, two-start pitchers)
- Statcast quality metrics (expected stats vs actual — who's due for a breakout?)
- Injury-driven opportunities (closer vacancies, lineup openings)

Then AI analyzes my roster's weak spots and recommends specific add/drop moves with reasoning tied to my team's needs. It knows that in my league, a closer producing 35 saves generates 245 points from saves alone — so it prioritizes accordingly.

Player Intelligence

Every player name in the app is clickable, opening a detailed profile with:

- Full batting or pitching stats across multiple seasons
- Statcast quality metrics (exit velocity, barrel rate, expected stats)
- Direct links to their [FanGraphs](#) player page for the full deep dive
- Buy/sell signals based on expected vs actual performance — the nerdy way of finding who's getting lucky and who's about to break out

- Multi-system projection comparison (Steamer, ZiPS, ATC blended)
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Yahoo Fantasy Integration

The app connects directly to my Yahoo Fantasy league and understands:

- My exact roster and position assignments
- My league's custom H2H Points scoring system (every category weighted differently)
- All 10 teams' rosters, standings, and matchup schedules
- Waiver wire availability and roster moves

Every AI feature uses this real league data — nothing is generic. When the app tells me to start a player, it's because it knows my scoring system, my opponent's roster, and what the matchups look like this week.

How It All Connects

The intelligence pipeline creates a feedback loop:

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Expert Content (articles + podcasts)
    ↓
  AI Daily Briefing (personalized to my league)
    ↓
Feeds into → Lineup Analysis
Feeds into → Weekly Preview
    ↓
I make better decisions (hopefully)
```

The daily briefing isn't just a standalone report — its insights flow into the lineup optimizer and weekly preview, so every AI feature in the app benefits from the latest expert analysis.

This app was built almost entirely through vibe coding with [Claude Code](#) in Visual Studio Code by [Brian Renshaw](#) — plus a lot of research into baseball APIs (Yahoo Fantasy, FanGraphs, Statcast, Baseball Reference, MLB Stats API), projection systems, and a whole lot of baseball nerdery.